

Data Appendix

This Data Appendix documents the datasets used to analyze whether quantified sentiment measures from the HAC meeting minutes improved predicted forecasts of month Charlottesville housing prices taken from CAAR data.

Combined Dataset:

The unit of observation is in the calendar months of 2025 in which there was a CAAR dataset available to the public. The median price of housing prices in each individual month, along with a sentiment score, is in this dataset.

Codebook:

Variable Name	Description	Example Values
month_year	Month and year of observation	2025-03, 2025-11
median_price	Monthly median home prices	415000, 800000
median_price_change_pct	Monthly median housing price changes	0.1, -0.64
sentiment_score	Quantified measure of sentiment language	0.06, 0.7
sales_volume	Number of housing sales per month	180, 135
uncertainty_mentions	Number of uncertainty words in the meeting mins	10, 17
uncertainty_score	Quantified measure of uncertainty-related language	0.014, 0.05
minutes_word_length	Total number of words in meeting mins	3600, 2900

Table 1: combined_housing_sentiment.csv

Variable Name	Description	Example Values
file_name	Name of the meeting minute file	HAC Minutes_03-19-2025.pdf
start_time	Start time of the HAC meeting	12:09 PM, 12:01 PM
end_time	End time of the HAC meeting	1:31 PM, 12:58 PM
housing_mentions	Number of housing words in meeting minutes	51, 30
uncertainty_mentions	Number of uncertainty words in meeting minutes	10, 17
housing_uncertainty_sentences	Number of sentences with housing and uncertainty words	4, 7
minutes_word_length	Total words in meeting minutes	1605, 1740
month_year	Date of the meeting	2025-03, 2025-12
uncertainty_score	Number of uncertainty words with respect to the total number of words in the meeting minutes	0.17, 0.2

Table 2: housing_uncertainty_with_score.csv

Variable Name	Description	Example Values
file_name	Name of the CAAR report file	25-07-market-indicator-report.pdf
sales_volume	Number of housing sales per month	180, 135
median_price	Monthly median home prices	415000, 800000

Table 3: caar_data.csv